
BRIDGE: Balancing Representations by Identifying and Generating Underrepresented Data

Anonymous Author(s)

Affiliation

Address

email

Abstract

1 Self supervised pretraining inherits the sampling bias of its source data. Most
2 remedies for long tailed self supervised learning are model centric. They change
3 the loss, schedule, or optimization dynamics while leaving the training distribution
4 fixed. We study a data centric alternative. BRIDGE alternates between self super-
5 vised pretraining, non parametric OOD scoring in representation space, and tar-
6 geted image generation with a frozen diffusion model. The final method replaces
7 our earlier extreme tail selector with a histogram based mode window that targets
8 a dense sparse band and avoids the visually noisy far tail. Across ImageNet-100-
9 LT, CIFAR-10-LT, CIFAR-100-LT, PASS, and DiffusionDB source pretraining,
10 BRIDGE achieves the best average linear probe transfer among the methods we
11 evaluate. On ImageNet-100-LT source pretraining, BRIDGE improves average
12 linear transfer over imbalanced SimCLR by 3.05 points. Across the five source
13 regimes, the gain over source matched SimCLR ranges from 2.41 to 4.89 points.
14 Ablations show that Stable Diffusion 3 is the strongest generator, SimCLR is the
15 strongest SSL objective for the repair loop, and the new mode window selector im-
16 proves over the older top tail rule, although uniform sampling remains competitive
17 in the isolated selection ablation. Full linear and k NN tables, additional support-
18 ing figures, runtime statistics, and license notes are provided in the appendix.

19 1 Introduction

20 Self supervised learning has become a standard tool for learning transferable visual representations
21 from unlabeled images. Strong methods now span contrastive learning, masked prediction, and self
22 distillation [Chen et al., 2020, He et al., 2020, 2022, Caron et al., 2021, Oquab et al., 2024]. Yet
23 these methods still inherit the sampling bias of the source corpus. When the source data is long
24 tailed or otherwise skewed, the learned embedding allocates most of its capacity to dense majority
25 regions and leaves sparse regions weakly modeled. This hurts transfer, especially on fine grained
26 tasks and tail heavy recognition settings.

27 Most prior attempts to address long tailed SSL are model centric. Temperature Schedules reshapes
28 the optimization trajectory of contrastive learning over time [Kukleva et al., 2023]. SDCLR intro-
29 duces a self competitor to emphasize harder and rarer samples [Jiang et al., 2021]. Other work adds
30 external OOD data or frequency aware training heuristics to the SSL loop [Bai et al., 2023, Lin et al.,
31 2023]. These are effective ideas, but they still treat the source distribution as mostly fixed.

32 We study the complementary direction. Can we repair the source dataset itself while training pro-
33 ceeds? Our answer is BRIDGE, a cyclic data repair loop. After each pretraining stage, we embed
34 the current training set, score each image by mean k NN distance, select a sparse but semantically
35 recoverable region of the representation space, and generate new training images for that region
36 with a frozen diffusion model. The next cycle trains on the expanded dataset. The encoder therefore

37 exposes where the data manifold is thin, and generation densifies those weak regions before the next
38 round of learning.

39 The submission differs from our earlier draft in two important ways. First, the main method no
40 longer selects the most extreme OOD samples. Instead it builds a histogram over OOD distances and
41 draws a fixed budget around the mode of that histogram. This skips the super OOD tail, which often
42 contains noisy or weakly useful images. The old tail only rule is retained as an ablation. Second, the
43 empirical scope now extends beyond ImageNet derived long tails. In addition to ImageNet-100-LT,
44 CIFAR-10-LT, and CIFAR-100-LT, we evaluate web scale unlabeled source data from PASS and
45 DiffusionDB.

46 This paper makes three contributions. First, it introduces a data centric SSL loop that repairs sparse
47 representation regions with frozen diffusion augmentation. Second, it replaces pure tail selection
48 with a histogram based mode window that is better aligned with semantically recoverable sparse
49 regions and improves over the older top tail rule. Third, it provides a broad empirical study across
50 five source regimes, seven downstream tasks, three seeds, strong baselines, and targeted ablations.

51 2 Related Work

52 **Self supervised visual representation learning.** Modern vision SSL is dominated by contrastive
53 methods such as SimCLR and MoCo [Chen et al., 2020, He et al., 2020], self distillation methods
54 such as DINO [Caron et al., 2021], and masked prediction methods such as MAE [He et al., 2022].
55 These methods have made unlabeled pretraining routine, but they usually take the source dataset as
56 given.

57 **Long tailed and imbalanced SSL.** Long tailed data changes both optimization and representation
58 geometry. TS addresses this with a schedule over the contrastive temperature [Kukleva et al., 2023].
59 SDCLR prunes a self competitor to emphasize hard and tail examples [Jiang et al., 2021]. FASSL
60 introduces frequency aware SSL training [Lin et al., 2023]. COLT injects external OOD data into
61 long tail SSL [Bai et al., 2023]. Our setting is different. BRIDGE does not modify the core SSL
62 loss and does not require a separate external OOD collection. It repairs sparse regions using images
63 generated from the training data already in hand.

64 **OOD scoring and data curation.** Data centric AI emphasizes that dataset composition is often as
65 important as model design [Whang et al., 2023]. For our setting, the scoring rule must work without
66 labels, density estimation assumptions, or class frequency estimates. Mean deep nearest neighbor
67 distance satisfies these constraints and has been effective for OOD detection in high dimensional
68 representation spaces [Sun et al., 2022].

69 **Diffusion based augmentation.** Diffusion models enable high quality image synthesis with strong
70 semantic control [Ho et al., 2020, Rombach et al., 2022]. Prior long tail work has often used gener-
71 ated images in supervised settings. Our use is different. A frozen image to image diffusion model
72 serves as a repair operator inside an SSL loop. Generation is targeted at sparse representation regions
73 instead of globally sampled prompts.

74 3 Method

75 3.1 Setting and repair loop

76 Let $D^{(0)} = \{x_i\}_{i=1}^{N_0}$ denote an unlabeled source dataset and let f_θ be an SSL encoder trained with
77 objective $\mathcal{L}_{\text{ssl}}$. BRIDGE alternates between pretraining and dataset repair over C cycles. At cycle c ,
78 the current encoder is $f_{\theta^{(c)}}$ and the current source set is $D^{(c)}$.

79 After training on $D^{(c)}$, we embed every image and compute a non parametric OOD score from mean
80 k NN distance,

$$z_i^{(c)} = f_{\theta^{(c)}}(x_i), \quad d_i^{(c)} = \frac{1}{k} \sum_{j=1}^k \left\| z_i^{(c)} - \pi_j \left(z_i^{(c)} \right) \right\|_2^2, \quad (1)$$

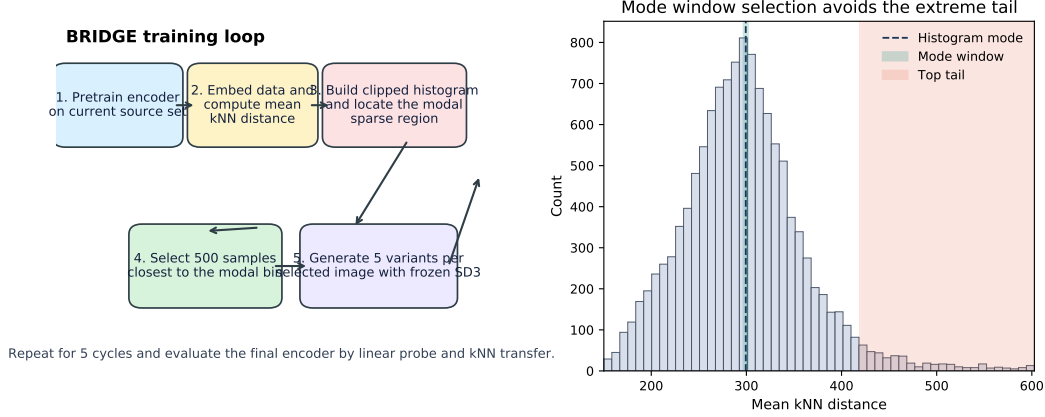


Figure 1: Left: the BRIDGE repair loop. Right: the new mode window selector on a representative OOD histogram. The new selector targets the densest sparse band instead of the extreme right tail.

81 where $\pi_j(z_i^{(c)})$ is the j th nearest neighbor of $z_i^{(c)}$ inside the current training set. Large values
 82 indicate that an image lies in a sparse part of the learned representation space.

83 3.2 Mode window OOD selection

84 The old version of our method selected the largest OOD scores directly. That rule is simple but
 85 brittle. The farthest samples are often visually noisy, outlying even relative to the sparse regions that
 86 are still semantically useful for repair.

87 Our current selector therefore works in two steps. First, it clips the empirical OOD distribution to its
 88 1% to 99% quantile range and builds a histogram over the clipped values. Let b^* denote the modal
 89 bin and let $m^{(c)}$ denote the center of that bin. Second, given an augmentation budget B , we select
 90 the B samples whose OOD scores are closest to $m^{(c)}$,

$$S^{(c)} = \arg \text{top-} B_i - \left| d_i^{(c)} - m^{(c)} \right|. \quad (2)$$

91 This is a symmetric selection around the densest sparse region rather than a direct grab of the farthest
 92 tail. Figure 1 illustrates the mechanism, and Appendix Figure 4 shows that the OOD shoulder can
 93 move substantially across training.

94 3.3 Diffusion based repair

95 Given the selected set $S^{(c)}$, we generate G synthetic variants per selected image with a frozen image
 96 to image diffusion model g_ϕ . In the main method we use Stable Diffusion 3. The generation ablation
 97 replaces it with FLUX or with a no generation re population baseline. The repaired source set is

$$D^{(c+1)} = D^{(c)} \cup \left\{ g_\phi(x, \epsilon_j) \mid x \in S^{(c)}, j = 1, \dots, G \right\}. \quad (3)$$

98 Because the generator is frozen, the learned component remains the SSL encoder. The repair loop
 99 is therefore compatible with any SSL objective that can provide embeddings for OOD scoring.

100 3.4 Design rationale

101 The key choice is that we do not try to densify the most isolated samples at all cost. The farthest tail
 102 often contains degenerate crops, artifacts, or images whose semantics are too unstable for reliable
 103 image to image augmentation. The histogram mode captures a more useful target. It finds images
 104 that are underrepresented relative to the main body of the representation space, yet still belong to
 105 a coherent local neighborhood. In the completed selection ablation, this change improves average
 106 linear transfer by 0.32 points and average k NN transfer by 0.77 points over the older top tail rule on
 107 ImageNet-100-LT. Uniform sampling remains competitive in that isolated ablation, so we interpret
 108 the mode window as a better replacement for pure tail selection rather than as a universally dominant
 109 selector.

Table 1: Linear probe comparison between balanced pretraining, imbalanced pretraining, and BRIDGE on ImageNet-100-LT. The reported average is over all seven downstream linear-probe tasks, including Cars and Aircraft.

Method	C10	C100	Flowers	Pets	IN100-LT	Avg.
Balanced	65.3 $\pm$ 1.2	37.0 $\pm$ 0.8	22.4 $\pm$ 1.6	31.2 $\pm$ 2.0	39.0 $\pm$ 1.0	31.1 $\pm$ 1.1
Imbalanced	65.4 $\pm$ 4.2	38.6 $\pm$ 1.4	23.7 $\pm$ 1.0	28.4 $\pm$ 1.3	39.6 $\pm$ 0.3	31.2 $\pm$ 1.4
BRIDGE (ours)	70.7 $\pm$ 1.7	43.3 $\pm$ 0.6	26.6 $\pm$ 2.7	31.2 $\pm$ 3.7	42.0 $\pm$ 1.2	34.3 $\pm$ 1.8

4 Experimental Setup

Source datasets. We pretrain on five unlabeled source regimes. Three are long tailed image classification datasets, namely ImageNet-100-LT, CIFAR-10-LT, and CIFAR-100-LT. Two are web scale unlabeled corpora, namely PASS [Asano et al., 2021] and DiffusionDB [Wang et al., 2023]. For PASS and DiffusionDB we use 10k example subsets and override the pretraining split to [1.0, 0.0, 0.0], so all sampled images are used for SSL pretraining.

Downstream evaluation. We evaluate transfer on seven benchmarks: CIFAR-10-LT, CIFAR-100-LT, Stanford Cars [Krause et al., 2013], FGVC Aircraft [Maji et al., 2013], Oxford Flowers [Nilsback and Zisserman, 2008], Oxford-IIIT Pets [Parkhi et al., 2012], and ImageNet-100-LT. The main paper reports linear probe results. Full linear probe and k NN tables are deferred to the appendix.

Training protocol. All reported numbers are mean $\pm$ standard deviation over three seeds. The main backbone is ResNet-50. Unless noted otherwise, BRIDGE uses $k = 100$ for OOD scoring, selects 500 images per cycle, generates 5 images per selected image, and trains for 5 cycles with 100 epochs per cycle. The cycle ablation changes the number of cycles while adjusting the per cycle budget accordingly. The successful DINO ablation uses two local crops. Appendix B gives additional implementation details, runtime summaries, and asset notes.

Compared methods. We compare SimCLR, TS, SDCLR, BRIDGE, and two hybrids that combine BRIDGE with TS or SDCLR. The combinations are natural because BRIDGE changes the data while TS and SDCLR change the optimization dynamics.

5 Results

5.1 Balanced and imbalanced baselines

Table 1 compares balanced pretraining, imbalanced pretraining, and BRIDGE on ImageNet-100-LT source data. BRIDGE improves the seven task average linear probe score by 3.05 points over the imbalanced baseline and by 3.14 points over the balanced baseline. The gains are broad rather than isolated. Relative to imbalanced SimCLR, BRIDGE improves CIFAR-10-LT by 5.37 points, CIFAR-100-LT by 4.71 points, Flowers by 2.83 points, and ImageNet-100-LT transfer by 2.35 points.

5.2 Comparison across source datasets

Table 2 reports the average linear transfer over all seven downstream tasks for each source regime. BRIDGE achieves the best average linear transfer in all five source regimes that we evaluate. Relative to source matched SimCLR, the average gain is +2.41 points on ImageNet-100-LT, +3.15 on CIFAR-10-LT, +4.89 on CIFAR-100-LT, +3.15 on PASS, and +2.54 on DiffusionDB. Appendix Figure 2 visualizes the same trend.

The detailed pattern is also informative. Plain BRIDGE is the strongest average transfer method in every regime. BRIDGE+TS is the strongest method on the in domain ImageNet-100-LT target when the source is PASS or DiffusionDB, but those target gains do not translate into the best overall average transfer. SDCLR and BRIDGE+SDCLR are consistently weaker in our setting.

5.3 Ablations

Table 3 summarizes the most important ablations. Three conclusions are stable.

Table 2: Average linear-probe transfer over all seven downstream tasks. The full per-task linear and k NN tables are deferred to the appendix.

Source	SimCLR	TS	SDCLR	BRIDGE	BRIDGE+TS	BRIDGE+SDCLR
ImageNet-100-LT	39.8 ± 1.5	39.6 ± 1.1	15.1 ± 0.8	42.3 ± 1.0	35.7 ± 1.0	15.2 ± 0.8
CIFAR-10-LT	29.1 ± 0.9	26.2 ± 1.3	13.8 ± 1.1	32.2 ± 1.6	28.5 ± 0.9	13.3 ± 0.9
CIFAR-100-LT	23.8 ± 1.4	21.9 ± 1.2	13.2 ± 0.7	28.7 ± 1.8	27.1 ± 2.6	13.2 ± 1.0
PASS-10k	36.8 ± 0.8	37.3 ± 0.9	14.8 ± 0.9	40.0 ± 1.0	36.0 ± 1.1	16.1 ± 0.8
DiffusionDB-10k	37.7 ± 0.9	37.8 ± 0.8	15.2 ± 0.9	40.3 ± 1.2	35.4 ± 1.0	15.5 ± 1.1

Table 3: Summary of the most important ablations on ImageNet-100-LT. Average columns are computed over all seven downstream tasks.

Group	Setting	Avg. Lin.	Avg. kNN	Flowers	Pets	IN100-LT
SSL objective	SimCLR	34.7 ± 1.2	28.1 ± 0.6	27.2 ± 1.5	33.2 ± 3.3	41.7 ± 1.3
	MoCo	17.8 ± 1.9	20.5 ± 0.8	10.4 ± 3.2	15.0 ± 1.8	26.6 ± 1.9
	DINO	15.2 ± 1.3	10.4 ± 0.4	12.6 ± 4.4	8.7 ± 1.6	20.6 ± 1.1
Generation	Stable Diffusion 3	41.4 ± 0.8	32.7 ± 0.4	37.4 ± 2.0	41.2 ± 0.7	51.8 ± 1.1
	FLUX	35.0 ± 1.9	28.8 ± 1.0	29.4 ± 4.6	31.5 ± 2.9	43.7 ± 1.4
	Re-population	32.6 ± 1.7	26.5 ± 0.5	25.7 ± 1.4	31.7 ± 3.8	40.6 ± 0.5
Selection	Mode window	34.6 ± 1.3	28.1 ± 0.6	27.9 ± 3.1	31.6 ± 3.3	41.7 ± 1.3
	Top tail	34.3 ± 1.2	27.3 ± 0.6	27.7 ± 1.0	30.5 ± 1.2	42.2 ± 1.4
	Uniform	35.5 ± 1.2	28.4 ± 0.6	32.9 ± 0.4	31.7 ± 3.9	42.0 ± 0.9

First, SimCLR is the strongest SSL objective for the cyclic repair loop. It substantially outperforms MoCo and DINO on both average linear and average k NN transfer. Second, generation quality matters. Stable Diffusion 3 is clearly stronger than FLUX and stronger than the no generation re population baseline, which indicates that the repaired data must be both targeted and semantically plausible. Third, the new MODEWINDOW selector improves over the older TOPTAIL rule. Uniform sampling remains slightly stronger in this isolated selection ablation, which suggests that once the candidate budget is already small, diversity and locality can both be useful. Appendix Figure 3 summarizes these tradeoffs visually.

6 Limitations

BRIDGE is more expensive than fixed data SSL because every cycle requires feature extraction, OOD scoring, and image generation. The successful experiments reported here use a specific compute regime based on A100 nodes and 24 hour wall time limits, and Appendix C shows that total project compute is substantial. The PASS and DiffusionDB experiments are limited to 10k subsets for tractability. The main paper also centers the final comparison on ResNet-50, even though the appendix includes broader architecture ablations. Finally, the submission does not benchmark newer post project methods that appeared after the original draft.

7 Conclusion

The experiments support a simple conclusion. Long tail SSL is not only an optimization problem. It is also a data geometry problem. By repeatedly identifying sparse representation regions and repairing them with frozen diffusion augmentation, BRIDGE improves average transfer across conventional long tailed sources and across two web scale unlabeled sources. The new mode window selector is important because it replaces an overly literal extreme tail rule with a more stable target region. Within the completed experimental protocol, BRIDGE is the strongest average transfer method across all five source regimes that we study.

References

Yuki Asano, Christian Rupprecht, Andrew Zisserman, and Andrea Vedaldi. PASS: An ImageNet replacement for self-supervised pretraining without humans. In Joaquin Vanschoren and Serena Yeung, editors, *Proceedings of the Neural Information Processing Systems Track on Datasets and Benchmarks*, volume 1, 2021. URL <https://>

177 //datasets-benchmarks-proceedings.neurips.cc/paper_files/paper/2021/file/
178 0777d5c17d4066b82ab86dff8a46af6f-Paper-round1.pdf.

179 Jianhong Bai, Zuozhu Liu, Hualiang Wang, Jin Hao, Yan Feng, Huanpeng Chu, and Haoji Hu. On
180 the effectiveness of out-of-distribution data in self-supervised long-tail learning. In *The Eleventh
181 International Conference on Learning Representations*, 2023. URL [https://openreview.
182 net/forum?id=v8JIQdiN9Sh](https://openreview.net/forum?id=v8JIQdiN9Sh). Published as a conference paper at ICLR 2023.

183 Mathilde Caron, Hugo Touvron, Ishan Misra, Hervé Jégou, Julien Mairal, Piotr Bojanowski,
184 and Armand Joulin. Emerging properties in self-supervised vision transformers. In
185 *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV)*,
186 pages 9650–9660. IEEE, October 2021. doi: 10.1109/ICCV48922.2021.00951. URL
187 [https://openaccess.thecvf.com/content/ICCV2021/html/Caron_Emerging_
188 Properties_in_Self-Supervised_Vision_Transformers_ICCV_2021_paper.html](https://openaccess.thecvf.com/content/ICCV2021/html/Caron_Emerging_Properties_in_Self-Supervised_Vision_Transformers_ICCV_2021_paper.html).

189 Ting Chen, Simon Kornblith, Mohammad Norouzi, and Geoffrey Hinton. A simple framework
190 for contrastive learning of visual representations. In Hal Daumé III and Aarti Singh, editors,
191 *Proceedings of the 37th International Conference on Machine Learning*, volume 119 of *Pro-
192 ceedings of Machine Learning Research*, pages 1597–1607. PMLR, 13–18 Jul 2020. URL
193 <https://proceedings.mlr.press/v119/chen20j.html>.

194 Kaiming He, Haoqi Fan, Yuxin Wu, Saining Xie, and Ross Girshick. Momentum contrast
195 for unsupervised visual representation learning. In *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Con-
196 ference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)*, pages 9729–9738. IEEE,
197 June 2020. doi: 10.1109/CVPR42600.2020.00975. URL [https://openaccess.thecvf.
198 com/content_CVPR_2020/html/He_Momentum_Contrast_for_Unsupervised_Visual_
199 Representation_Learning_CVPR_2020_paper.html](https://openaccess.thecvf.com/content_CVPR_2020/html/He_Momentum_Contrast_for_Unsupervised_Visual_Representation_Learning_CVPR_2020_paper.html).

200 Kaiming He, Xinlei Chen, Saining Xie, Yanghao Li, Piotr Dollár, and Ross Girshick. Masked
201 autoencoders are scalable vision learners. In *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Conference
202 on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)*, pages 16000–16009. IEEE, June
203 2022. URL [https://openaccess.thecvf.com/content/CVPR2022/html/He_Masked_
204 Autoencoders_Are_Scalable_Vision_Learners_CVPR_2022_paper.html](https://openaccess.thecvf.com/content/CVPR2022/html/He_Masked_Autoencoders_Are_Scalable_Vision_Learners_CVPR_2022_paper.html).

205 Jonathan Ho, Ajay Jain, and Pieter Abbeel. Denoising diffusion probabilistic models. In Hugo
206 Larochelle, Marc’Aurelio Ranzato, Raia Hadsell, Maria-Florina Balcan, and Hsuan-Tien Lin, ed-
207 itors, *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems*, volume 33, pages 6840–6851. Cur-
208 ran Associates, Inc., 2020. URL [https://proceedings.neurips.cc/paper_files/paper/
209 2020/file/4c5bcfec8584af0d967f1ab10179ca4b-Paper.pdf](https://proceedings.neurips.cc/paper_files/paper/2020/file/4c5bcfec8584af0d967f1ab10179ca4b-Paper.pdf).

210 Ziyu Jiang, Tianlong Chen, Bobak J. Mortazavi, and Zhangyang Wang. Self-damaging contrastive
211 learning. In Marina Meila and Tong Zhang, editors, *Proceedings of the 38th International
212 Conference on Machine Learning*, volume 139 of *Proceedings of Machine Learning Research*,
213 pages 4927–4939. PMLR, 18–24 Jul 2021. URL [https://proceedings.mlr.press/v139/
214 jiang21a.html](https://proceedings.mlr.press/v139/jiang21a.html).

215 Jonathan Krause, Michael Stark, Jia Deng, and Li Fei-Fei. 3d object representations for fine-grained
216 categorization. In *2013 IEEE International Conference on Computer Vision Workshops*, pages
217 554–561. IEEE, 2013. doi: 10.1109/ICCVW.2013.77. URL [https://doi.org/10.1109/
218 ICCVW.2013.77](https://doi.org/10.1109/ICCVW.2013.77).

219 Anna Kukleva, Moritz Böhle, Bernt Schiele, Hilde Kuehne, and Christian Rupprecht. Temperature
220 schedules for self-supervised contrastive methods on long-tail data. In *The Eleventh International
221 Conference on Learning Representations*, 2023. URL [https://openreview.net/forum?id=
222 ejHUr4nfHhD](https://openreview.net/forum?id=ejHUr4nfHhD). Published as a conference paper at ICLR 2023.

223 Ci-Siang Lin, Min-Hung Chen, and Yu-Chiang Frank Wang. Frequency-aware self-
224 supervised long-tailed learning. In *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF International Confer-
225 ence on Computer Vision (ICCV) Workshops*, pages 963–972. IEEE, October 2023. doi:
226 10.1109/ICCVW60793.2023.00103. URL [https://openaccess.thecvf.com/content/
227 ICCV2023W/LIMIT/html/Lin_Frequency-Aware_Self-Supervised_Long-Tailed_
228 Learning_ICCVW_2023_paper.html](https://openaccess.thecvf.com/content/ICCV2023W/LIMIT/html/Lin_Frequency-Aware_Self-Supervised_Long-Tailed_Learning_ICCVW_2023_paper.html).

- Subhransu Maji, Esa Rahtu, Juho Kannala, Matthew B. Blaschko, and Andrea Vedaldi. Fine-grained visual classification of aircraft, 2013. URL <https://arxiv.org/abs/1306.5151>.
- Maria-Elena Nilsback and Andrew Zisserman. Automated flower classification over a large number of classes. In *2008 Sixth Indian Conference on Computer Vision, Graphics & Image Processing*, pages 722–729. IEEE, 2008. doi: 10.1109/ICVGIP.2008.47. URL <https://doi.org/10.1109/ICVGIP.2008.47>.
- Maxime Oquab, Timothée Darcet, Théo Moutakanni, Huy Vo, Marc Szafraniec, Vasil Khalidov, Pierre Fernandez, Daniel Haziza, Francisco Massa, Alaaeldin El-Nouby, Mahmoud Assran, Nicolas Ballas, Wojciech Galuba, Russell Howes, Po-Yao Huang, Shang-Wen Li, Ishan Misra, Michael Rabbat, Vasu Sharma, Gabriel Synnaeve, Hu Xu, Hervé Jégou, Julien Mairal, Patrick Labatut, Armand Joulin, and Piotr Bojanowski. DINOv2: Learning robust visual features without supervision. *Transactions on Machine Learning Research*, 2024. URL <https://openreview.net/forum?id=a68SUt6zFt>. Published 05/2024.
- Omkar M. Parkhi, Andrea Vedaldi, Andrew Zisserman, and C. V. Jawahar. Cats and dogs. In *2012 IEEE Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition*, pages 3498–3505. IEEE, 2012. doi: 10.1109/CVPR.2012.6248092. URL <https://doi.org/10.1109/CVPR.2012.6248092>.
- Robin Rombach, Andreas Blattmann, Dominik Lorenz, Patrick Esser, and Björn Ommer. High-resolution image synthesis with latent diffusion models. In *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)*, pages 10684–10695. IEEE, June 2022. URL https://openaccess.thecvf.com/content/CVPR2022/html/Rombach_High-Resolution_Image_Synthesis_With_Latent_Diffusion_Models_CVPR_2022_paper.html.
- Yiyu Sun, Yifei Ming, Xiaojin Zhu, and Yixuan Li. Out-of-distribution detection with deep nearest neighbors. In Kamalika Chaudhuri, Stefanie Jegelka, Le Song, Csaba Szepesvári, Gang Niu, and Sivan Sabato, editors, *Proceedings of the 39th International Conference on Machine Learning*, volume 162 of *Proceedings of Machine Learning Research*, pages 20827–20840. PMLR, 17–23 Jul 2022. URL <https://proceedings.mlr.press/v162/sun22d.html>.
- Zijie J. Wang, Evan Montoya, David Munechika, Haoyang Yang, Benjamin Hoover, and Duen Horng Chau. DiffusionDB: A large-scale prompt gallery dataset for text-to-image generative models. In Anna Rogers, Jordan Boyd-Graber, and Naoaki Okazaki, editors, *Proceedings of the 61st Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, pages 893–911, Toronto, Canada, July 2023. Association for Computational Linguistics. doi: 10.18653/v1/2023.acl-long.51. URL <https://aclanthology.org/2023.acl-long.51/>.
- Steven Euijong Whang, Yuji Roh, Hwanjun Song, and Jae-Gil Lee. Data collection and quality challenges in deep learning: A data-centric AI perspective. *The VLDB Journal*, 32(4): 791–813, 2023. doi: 10.1007/s00778-022-00775-9. URL <https://doi.org/10.1007/s00778-022-00775-9>.

A Additional Supporting Figures

B Implementation and Reproducibility

Core training configuration. The completed main runs use ResNet-50 encoders. Most baseline, BRIDGE, and source regime comparisons use 5 cycles with 100 epochs per cycle. The default BRIDGE configuration uses mean k NN distance with $k = 100$, selects 500 samples per cycle, and generates 5 images per selected sample. The default optimizer is AdamW with weight decay 10^{-4} , and method specific learning rates and temperatures follow the completed job configurations.

OOD scoring and selection. Features are extracted without feature normalization and nearest neighbor distances are computed with FAISS using squared ℓ_2 distance. The mode window selector clips the empirical OOD distribution to the 1st to 99th percentile range, builds a histogram with the code level auto bin heuristic, and selects the examples closest to the modal bin center.

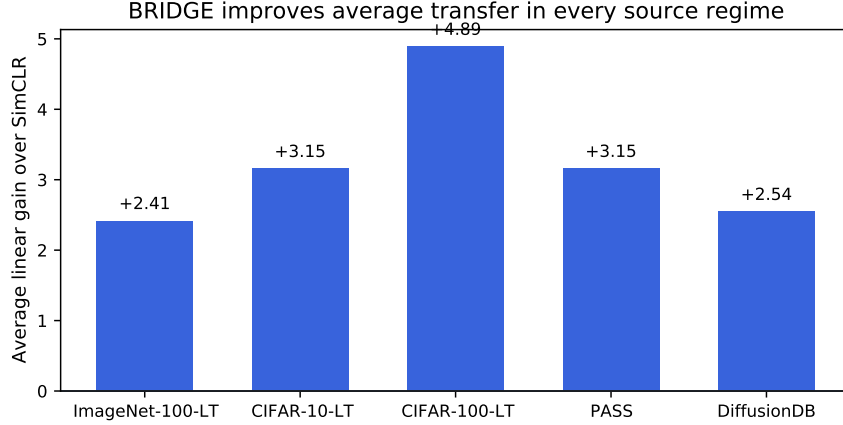


Figure 2: Average linear gain of BRIDGE over source matched SimCLR across all five source regimes. The gain is positive in every case.

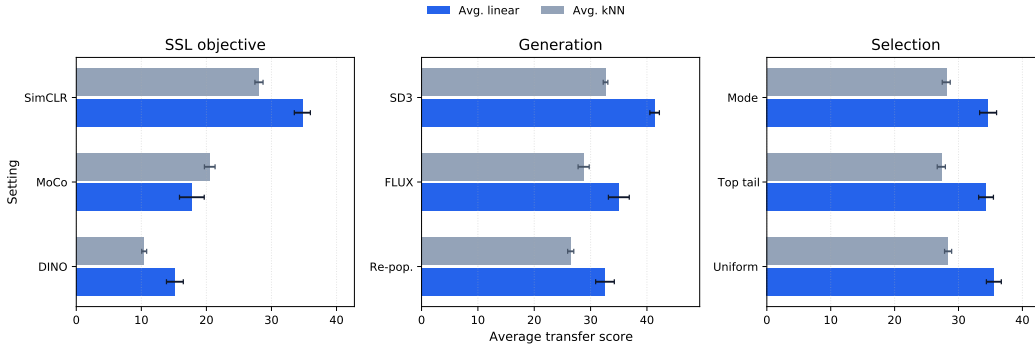


Figure 3: Average linear and average k NN transfer for the main ablation groups. Stable Diffusion 3 is the strongest generator, SimCLR is the strongest SSL objective, and the mode window selector improves over the older top tail rule while uniform sampling remains competitive.

278 **Generators.** The main method uses Stable Diffusion 3 in image to image mode. The generation
 279 ablation replaces it with FLUX or with a no generation re population baseline. In the completed
 280 PASS and DiffusionDB runs we increase the SD3 batch size to 12 to fit the 24 hour Slurm limit.

281 **Source data specifics.** PASS and DiffusionDB use `train[:10000]` with pretraining split over-
 282 ride `[1.0, 0.0, 0.0]`. This keeps the source data budget aligned across methods while avoiding
 283 unnecessary pretraining validation overhead. The long tailed ImageNet-100, CIFAR-10, and CIFAR-
 284 100 regimes follow the completed job configurations used in the final sweep.

285 **Seeds and reporting.** All main claims are supported by three seed averages. Tables report
 286 mean $\pm$ standard deviation over those seeds. The exact table values are generated from the
 287 completed job logs by the local export scripts in `scripts/export_paper_results.py` and
 288 `scripts/generate_neurips_paper_tables.py`.

289 C Compute Resources and Runtime

290 Most completed experiments use one node with two NVIDIA A100 80GB GPUs and a 24 hour wall
 291 time limit. The successful DINO ablation uses four A100 80GB GPUs after reducing the number
 292 of local crops from six to two. Over the successful experiments reported in the paper, the aggregate
 293 training time is approximately 3022 wall clock hours, or about 6142 GPU hours. This excludes

Representative OOD histograms shift across cycles

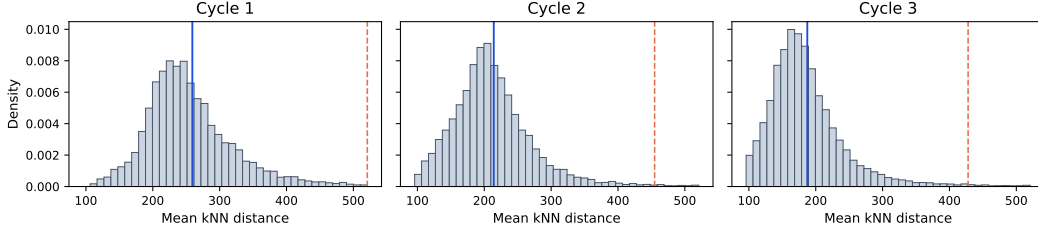


Figure 4: Representative OOD histograms from a successful ImageNet-100-LT TS run. The sparse shoulder moves across cycles, which motivates selecting around a local modal band rather than only the farthest tail.

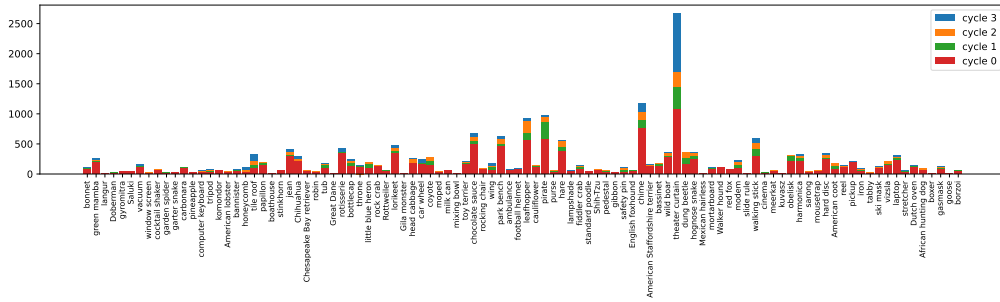


Figure 5: Class count evolution across BRIDGE cycles for a representative ImageNet-100-LT run. This figure is diagnostic only. The pretraining objective itself remains label free.

294 failed runs, timeout runs, cache migration jobs, and other debugging or pilot jobs, so the full project
 295 required more compute than the successful totals alone.

296 Representative mean wall clock times over three seeds are as follows. On ImageNet-100-LT source
 297 pretraining, SimCLR takes 16.9 hours and BRIDGE takes 21.8 hours. On PASS, SimCLR takes
 298 10.2 hours and BRIDGE takes 14.9 hours. On DiffusionDB, SimCLR takes 11.6 hours and BRIDGE
 299 takes 16.4 hours. The successful DINO ablation takes 16.3 hours on four GPUs in its final configu-
 300 ration.

301 D Assets and Terms of Use

302 We use existing datasets and pretrained generators under their original release terms.

303 **Source datasets.** ImageNet-100-LT is derived from ImageNet, whose official access terms restrict
 304 the images to non commercial research and educational use. PASS is released under Creative Com-
 305 mons Attribution 4.0. DiffusionDB is released under CC0-1.0. CIFAR-10, CIFAR-100, Stanford
 306 Cars, FGVC Aircraft, Oxford Flowers, and Oxford-IIIT Pets are used from their official academic
 307 benchmark releases. When an official page provides download terms instead of a standard software
 308 style license, we follow those original terms.

309 **Generators.** Stable Diffusion 3 Medium is used under the Stability AI Community License.
 310 FLUX.1-dev is used only in the ablation and is subject to the FLUX.1-dev Non-Commercial Li-
 311 cense. We do not redistribute model weights, third party datasets, or generated image corpora as
 312 part of this submission.

Table 4: Full linear-probe baseline comparison on ImageNet-100-LT pretraining.

Method	C10	C100	Cars	Aircraft	Flowers	Pets	IN100-LT	Avg.
Balanced	65.3 ± 1.2	37.0 ± 0.8	8.0 ± 0.5	15.1 ± 0.7	22.4 ± 1.6	31.2 ± 2.0	39.0 ± 1.0	31.1 ± 1.1
Imbalanced	65.4 ± 4.2	38.6 ± 1.4	7.6 ± 1.1	15.3 ± 0.9	23.7 ± 1.0	28.4 ± 1.3	39.6 ± 0.3	31.2 ± 1.4
BRIDGE (ours)	70.7 ± 1.7	43.3 ± 0.6	9.9 ± 1.5	16.4 ± 0.9	26.6 ± 2.7	31.2 ± 3.7	42.0 ± 1.2	34.3 ± 1.8

Table 5: Full kNN baseline comparison on ImageNet-100-LT pretraining.

Method	C10	C100	Cars	Aircraft	Flowers	Pets	IN100-LT	Avg.
Balanced	63.6 ± 0.7	32.8 ± 0.8	4.4 ± 0.4	9.0 ± 0.4	22.3 ± 0.1	17.2 ± 0.1	34.0 ± 1.1	26.2 ± 0.5
Imbalanced	63.9 ± 0.2	33.2 ± 0.3	4.5 ± 0.6	9.0 ± 0.3	22.5 ± 0.3	16.8 ± 0.2	34.3 ± 0.3	26.3 ± 0.3
BRIDGE (ours)	66.0 ± 0.9	35.0 ± 0.9	5.0 ± 0.4	9.8 ± 0.2	24.8 ± 0.4	18.0 ± 0.5	35.6 ± 1.2	27.7 ± 0.6

E Broader Impact

A method that improves representation quality under biased source data can reduce the need for manual relabeling and can make SSL more useful for domains where balanced data is difficult to collect. That is a positive outcome. At the same time, our method relies on large image generators and on web sourced datasets. These carry familiar risks related to license compliance, privacy, and unintended memorization or harmful content. Our experiments stay within existing dataset and model release terms and do not release new generators or scraped image collections. Any future deployment would still require a task specific review of fairness, privacy, and content safety.

F Full Results

G Algorithm

Algorithm 1 BRIDGE training loop

- 1: Initialize unlabeled source set $D^{(0)}$, encoder f_θ , frozen generator g_ϕ
 - 2: **for** $c = 0, \dots, C - 1$ **do**
 - 3: Pretrain f_θ on $D^{(c)}$ for E_c epochs
 - 4: Embed all images in $D^{(c)}$ and compute mean k NN distances $\{d_i^{(c)}\}$
 - 5: Clip the distance range, build a histogram, and find the modal bin center $m^{(c)}$
 - 6: Select B images whose OOD distances are closest to $m^{(c)}$
 - 7: Generate G synthetic images per selected image with frozen generator g_ϕ
 - 8: Form $D^{(c+1)}$ by adding the generated images to $D^{(c)}$
 - 9: **end for**
-

Table 6: Full linear-probe transfer results across all source datasets and comparison methods.

Source	Method	C10	C100	Cars	Aircraft	Flowers	Pets	IN100-LT	Avg.
ImageNet-100-LT	SimCLR	73.9 $\pm$ 0.5	46.8 $\pm$ 0.4	13.7 $\pm$ 0.3	19.6 $\pm$ 0.2	35.9 $\pm$ 7.2	38.6 $\pm$ 1.5	50.4 $\pm$ 0.5	39.8 $\pm$ 1.5
	TS	72.5 $\pm$ 0.4	44.0 $\pm$ 0.5	12.5 $\pm$ 1.2	15.0 $\pm$ 0.1	35.7 $\pm$ 1.8	40.6 $\pm$ 2.2	56.7 $\pm$ 1.2	39.6 $\pm$ 1.1
	SDCLR	41.1 $\pm$ 1.7	18.0 $\pm$ 0.6	1.4 $\pm$ 0.3	2.3 $\pm$ 0.5	10.8 $\pm$ 1.7	10.4 $\pm$ 0.3	21.9 $\pm$ 0.6	15.1 $\pm$ 0.8
	BRIDGE (ours)	75.7 $\pm$ 0.2	48.8 $\pm$ 0.3	16.1 $\pm$ 1.0	22.4 $\pm$ 0.3	36.4 $\pm$ 2.4	42.7 $\pm$ 1.9	53.7 $\pm$ 0.6	42.3 $\pm$ 1.0
	BRIDGE+TS (ours)	73.2 $\pm$ 0.1	45.5 $\pm$ 0.4	9.5 $\pm$ 1.2	13.0 $\pm$ 0.7	26.4 $\pm$ 2.7	34.4 $\pm$ 1.7	47.6 $\pm$ 0.6	35.7 $\pm$ 1.0
	BRIDGE+SDCLR (ours)	41.5 $\pm$ 0.5	17.7 $\pm$ 0.4	1.3 $\pm$ 0.3	2.4 $\pm$ 0.7	12.1 $\pm$ 0.8	10.5 $\pm$ 1.9	20.7 $\pm$ 1.0	15.2 $\pm$ 0.8
CIFAR-10-LT	SimCLR	67.8 $\pm$ 0.2	38.0 $\pm$ 1.0	6.5 $\pm$ 0.4	16.0 $\pm$ 0.9	19.2 $\pm$ 1.6	24.0 $\pm$ 1.3	32.0 $\pm$ 0.7	29.1 $\pm$ 0.9
	TS	68.5 $\pm$ 1.3	36.0 $\pm$ 1.7	4.3 $\pm$ 0.2	10.3 $\pm$ 0.1	13.1 $\pm$ 2.0	19.7 $\pm$ 2.3	31.5 $\pm$ 1.2	26.2 $\pm$ 1.3
	SDCLR	39.6 $\pm$ 1.1	15.6 $\pm$ 0.2	1.1 $\pm$ 0.1	2.4 $\pm$ 0.9	12.0 $\pm$ 1.6	9.1 $\pm$ 1.8	16.5 $\pm$ 1.6	13.8 $\pm$ 1.1
	BRIDGE (ours)	70.7 $\pm$ 2.1	41.5 $\pm$ 0.6	8.6 $\pm$ 0.4	17.0 $\pm$ 0.9	24.0 $\pm$ 3.2	29.4 $\pm$ 2.1	34.4 $\pm$ 1.5	32.2 $\pm$ 1.6
	BRIDGE+TS (ours)	73.1 $\pm$ 1.0	42.0 $\pm$ 0.3	4.4 $\pm$ 0.8	12.4 $\pm$ 0.5	10.2 $\pm$ 1.6	23.2 $\pm$ 1.2	34.2 $\pm$ 1.1	28.5 $\pm$ 0.9
	BRIDGE+SDCLR (ours)	39.1 $\pm$ 0.2	15.3 $\pm$ 1.0	1.1 $\pm$ 0.3	2.1 $\pm$ 0.6	8.9 $\pm$ 2.6	9.5 $\pm$ 1.1	16.8 $\pm$ 0.7	13.3 $\pm$ 0.9
CIFAR-100-LT	SimCLR	59.0 $\pm$ 1.5	31.1 $\pm$ 1.6	4.1 $\pm$ 0.3	11.2 $\pm$ 1.0	12.6 $\pm$ 3.4	20.1 $\pm$ 1.0	28.7 $\pm$ 1.3	23.8 $\pm$ 1.4
	TS	56.3 $\pm$ 0.2	28.0 $\pm$ 0.1	2.8 $\pm$ 0.6	8.5 $\pm$ 0.2	15.5 $\pm$ 2.5	16.2 $\pm$ 3.1	26.2 $\pm$ 1.8	21.9 $\pm$ 1.2
	SDCLR	37.1 $\pm$ 0.8	15.7 $\pm$ 0.2	1.9 $\pm$ 0.1	2.4 $\pm$ 0.7	9.4 $\pm$ 1.0	9.9 $\pm$ 1.7	16.2 $\pm$ 0.3	13.2 $\pm$ 0.7
	BRIDGE (ours)	66.8 $\pm$ 3.1	38.3 $\pm$ 2.2	6.2 $\pm$ 1.8	14.6 $\pm$ 1.6	19.8 $\pm$ 0.4	22.7 $\pm$ 2.3	32.6 $\pm$ 1.4	28.7 $\pm$ 1.8
	BRIDGE+TS (ours)	66.4 $\pm$ 3.3	38.0 $\pm$ 3.7	4.2 $\pm$ 1.0	10.9 $\pm$ 0.7	17.2 $\pm$ 3.6	21.6 $\pm$ 3.3	31.4 $\pm$ 2.3	27.1 $\pm$ 2.6
	BRIDGE+SDCLR (ours)	39.1 $\pm$ 1.9	14.9 $\pm$ 0.9	0.9 $\pm$ 0.2	3.0 $\pm$ 0.4	10.9 $\pm$ 2.5	7.9 $\pm$ 0.7	16.0 $\pm$ 0.3	13.2 $\pm$ 1.0
PASS-10k	SimCLR	72.3 $\pm$ 0.2	45.5 $\pm$ 0.5	11.0 $\pm$ 0.2	17.5 $\pm$ 1.4	33.3 $\pm$ 1.3	33.3 $\pm$ 0.9	44.7 $\pm$ 0.9	36.8 $\pm$ 0.8
	TS	71.5 $\pm$ 0.2	43.5 $\pm$ 0.4	10.2 $\pm$ 1.2	17.2 $\pm$ 0.2	33.1 $\pm$ 2.1	36.4 $\pm$ 1.8	49.4 $\pm$ 0.4	37.3 $\pm$ 0.9
	SDCLR	42.2 $\pm$ 1.1	17.7 $\pm$ 0.8	1.8 $\pm$ 0.3	2.2 $\pm$ 0.8	10.6 $\pm$ 1.3	8.2 $\pm$ 1.6	20.8 $\pm$ 0.4	14.8 $\pm$ 0.9
	BRIDGE (ours)	74.2 $\pm$ 0.2	47.4 $\pm$ 0.7	13.0 $\pm$ 1.2	20.4 $\pm$ 0.4	39.4 $\pm$ 3.4	35.8 $\pm$ 0.1	49.5 $\pm$ 1.0	40.0 $\pm$ 1.0
	BRIDGE+TS (ours)	69.1 $\pm$ 0.4	40.5 $\pm$ 0.8	12.1 $\pm$ 0.5	14.3 $\pm$ 0.3	32.7 $\pm$ 4.1	30.8 $\pm$ 1.0	52.6 $\pm$ 0.5	36.0 $\pm$ 1.1
	BRIDGE+SDCLR (ours)	45.5 $\pm$ 1.0	19.3 $\pm$ 0.2	1.5 $\pm$ 0.7	3.3 $\pm$ 0.2	11.0 $\pm$ 1.6	11.3 $\pm$ 1.2	20.9 $\pm$ 0.9	16.1 $\pm$ 0.8
DiffusionDB-10k	SimCLR	74.4 $\pm$ 0.5	48.6 $\pm$ 0.2	10.9 $\pm$ 0.7	17.6 $\pm$ 0.8	31.2 $\pm$ 2.4	36.1 $\pm$ 1.3	45.3 $\pm$ 0.5	37.7 $\pm$ 0.9
	TS	72.3 $\pm$ 0.3	44.4 $\pm$ 0.3	10.7 $\pm$ 0.6	15.4 $\pm$ 0.6	33.1 $\pm$ 1.1	39.9 $\pm$ 2.7	48.8 $\pm$ 0.2	37.8 $\pm$ 0.8
	SDCLR	42.4 $\pm$ 0.2	18.4 $\pm$ 0.2	1.1 $\pm$ 0.2	2.4 $\pm$ 0.1	13.0 $\pm$ 3.7	8.2 $\pm$ 1.4	21.0 $\pm$ 0.6	15.2 $\pm$ 0.9
	BRIDGE (ours)	76.2 $\pm$ 0.1	49.8 $\pm$ 0.1	12.4 $\pm$ 1.1	20.4 $\pm$ 0.2	36.1 $\pm$ 2.7	38.0 $\pm$ 3.2	48.9 $\pm$ 0.8	40.3 $\pm$ 1.2
	BRIDGE+TS (ours)	68.8 $\pm$ 0.1	40.2 $\pm$ 0.4	9.2 $\pm$ 1.1	12.8 $\pm$ 0.5	31.2 $\pm$ 2.4	34.8 $\pm$ 1.6	51.0 $\pm$ 0.6	35.4 $\pm$ 1.0
	BRIDGE+SDCLR (ours)	42.2 $\pm$ 0.7	17.6 $\pm$ 0.3	1.1 $\pm$ 0.6	2.4 $\pm$ 0.1	11.9 $\pm$ 3.6	11.7 $\pm$ 1.3	21.3 $\pm$ 0.8	15.5 $\pm$ 1.1

Table 7: Full kNN transfer results across all source datasets and comparison methods.

Source	Method	C10	C100	Cars	Aircraft	Flowers	Pets	IN100-LT	Avg.
ImageNet-100-LT	SimCLR	68.6 $\pm$ 0.4	37.3 $\pm$ 0.2	6.0 $\pm$ 0.7	11.2 $\pm$ 0.4	32.2 $\pm$ 0.7	23.6 $\pm$ 0.3	43.9 $\pm$ 0.9	31.8 $\pm$ 0.5
	TS	68.4 $\pm$ 0.3	36.5 $\pm$ 0.1	4.7 $\pm$ 0.2	8.3 $\pm$ 0.5	26.6 $\pm$ 1.0	23.6 $\pm$ 1.7	52.2 $\pm$ 0.5	31.5 $\pm$ 0.6
	SDCLR	32.5 $\pm$ 0.4	10.9 $\pm$ 0.2	1.0 $\pm$ 0.3	2.1 $\pm$ 0.1	10.7 $\pm$ 0.7	4.7 $\pm$ 0.2	11.2 $\pm$ 0.2	10.4 $\pm$ 0.3
	BRIDGE (ours)	68.9 $\pm$ 0.5	37.8 $\pm$ 0.1	6.9 $\pm$ 0.1	12.1 $\pm$ 0.2	36.0 $\pm$ 0.1	25.3 $\pm$ 0.9	48.2 $\pm$ 0.4	33.6 $\pm$ 0.3
	BRIDGE+TS (ours)	65.2 $\pm$ 0.2	33.7 $\pm$ 0.5	2.9 $\pm$ 0.4	6.6 $\pm$ 0.2	18.6 $\pm$ 0.4	15.8 $\pm$ 1.0	40.5 $\pm$ 0.8	26.2 $\pm$ 0.5
	BRIDGE+SDCLR (ours)	33.8 $\pm$ 0.4	11.5 $\pm$ 0.5	1.3 $\pm$ 0.4	2.0 $\pm$ 0.1	10.2 $\pm$ 0.7	4.9 $\pm$ 0.2	12.6 $\pm$ 0.6	10.9 $\pm$ 0.4
CIFAR-10-LT	SimCLR	66.9 $\pm$ 0.4	33.4 $\pm$ 0.3	3.7 $\pm$ 0.4	9.8 $\pm$ 0.7	16.5 $\pm$ 0.8	13.9 $\pm$ 0.8	24.0 $\pm$ 0.8	24.0 $\pm$ 0.6
	TS	66.3 $\pm$ 0.6	27.8 $\pm$ 0.4	2.4 $\pm$ 0.6	6.4 $\pm$ 0.2	10.5 $\pm$ 0.7	11.1 $\pm$ 0.4	22.0 $\pm$ 0.9	20.9 $\pm$ 0.5
	SDCLR	30.1 $\pm$ 0.3	10.0 $\pm$ 0.3	1.7 $\pm$ 0.3	2.2 $\pm$ 0.2	10.1 $\pm$ 0.7	4.4 $\pm$ 0.4	9.8 $\pm$ 0.3	9.7 $\pm$ 0.4
	BRIDGE (ours)	69.0 $\pm$ 1.2	35.2 $\pm$ 0.9	4.2 $\pm$ 0.6	10.4 $\pm$ 0.5	17.0 $\pm$ 0.6	15.2 $\pm$ 0.8	25.2 $\pm$ 0.5	25.2 $\pm$ 0.7
	BRIDGE+TS (ours)	67.7 $\pm$ 0.8	28.0 $\pm$ 0.8	2.1 $\pm$ 0.2	5.1 $\pm$ 0.7	8.1 $\pm$ 1.0	9.1 $\pm$ 0.8	21.8 $\pm$ 0.5	20.3 $\pm$ 0.7
	BRIDGE+SDCLR (ours)	31.3 $\pm$ 1.2	10.4 $\pm$ 0.5	1.0 $\pm$ 0.1	1.8 $\pm$ 0.3	9.6 $\pm$ 1.3	4.5 $\pm$ 0.1	10.1 $\pm$ 0.4	9.8 $\pm$ 0.6
CIFAR-100-LT	SimCLR	59.3 $\pm$ 0.8	30.1 $\pm$ 0.9	3.0 $\pm$ 0.3	7.4 $\pm$ 0.4	13.7 $\pm$ 0.2	10.8 $\pm$ 0.4	21.8 $\pm$ 1.1	20.9 $\pm$ 0.6
	TS	53.1 $\pm$ 0.6	24.6 $\pm$ 0.4	2.4 $\pm$ 0.4	5.5 $\pm$ 0.3	9.3 $\pm$ 0.4	8.3 $\pm$ 0.2	18.7 $\pm$ 1.0	17.4 $\pm$ 0.5
	SDCLR	25.7 $\pm$ 1.2	8.5 $\pm$ 0.6	0.9 $\pm$ 0.4	1.9 $\pm$ 0.2	7.3 $\pm$ 0.3	3.9 $\pm$ 0.3	8.3 $\pm$ 1.1	8.1 $\pm$ 0.6
	BRIDGE (ours)	62.5 $\pm$ 0.8	32.5 $\pm$ 0.3	3.7 $\pm$ 0.3	8.7 $\pm$ 0.5	14.1 $\pm$ 0.9	12.1 $\pm$ 0.7	23.0 $\pm$ 1.2	22.4 $\pm$ 0.7
	BRIDGE+TS (ours)	56.3 $\pm$ 1.2	27.8 $\pm$ 0.5	1.9 $\pm$ 0.0	4.8 $\pm$ 0.6	8.0 $\pm$ 1.0	9.0 $\pm$ 0.6	20.8 $\pm$ 0.8	18.4 $\pm$ 0.7
	BRIDGE+SDCLR (ours)	29.7 $\pm$ 2.2	9.8 $\pm$ 1.5	1.4 $\pm$ 0.4	2.3 $\pm$ 0.2	9.2 $\pm$ 1.1	4.8 $\pm$ 0.1	8.9 $\pm$ 0.6	9.4 $\pm$ 0.9
PASS-10k	SimCLR	67.2 $\pm$ 0.2	37.0 $\pm$ 0.3	5.4 $\pm$ 0.3	10.3 $\pm$ 0.5	30.4 $\pm$ 0.0	16.7 $\pm$ 0.5	38.3 $\pm$ 0.3	29.3 $\pm$ 0.3
	TS	65.2 $\pm$ 0.7	34.6 $\pm$ 0.3	4.4 $\pm$ 0.2	7.9 $\pm$ 0.2	24.5 $\pm$ 0.1	14.4 $\pm$ 0.4	39.3 $\pm$ 0.4	27.2 $\pm$ 0.3
	SDCLR	32.4 $\pm$ 1.5	11.5 $\pm$ 0.8	1.3 $\pm$ 0.2	2.0 $\pm$ 0.1	8.6 $\pm$ 0.7	5.2 $\pm$ 0.2	11.1 $\pm$ 0.8	10.3 $\pm$ 0.6
	BRIDGE (ours)	67.8 $\pm$ 0.6	37.1 $\pm$ 0.5	5.2 $\pm$ 0.4	10.8 $\pm$ 0.3	33.7 $\pm$ 0.6	17.9 $\pm$ 0.3	41.9 $\pm$ 0.4	30.6 $\pm$ 0.5
	BRIDGE+TS (ours)	59.0 $\pm$ 0.4	27.8 $\pm$ 0.5	3.3 $\pm$ 0.4	6.6 $\pm$ 0.0	23.3 $\pm$ 0.4	13.9 $\pm$ 0.3	39.2 $\pm$ 0.3	24.7 $\pm$ 0.3
	BRIDGE+SDCLR (ours)	37.9 $\pm$ 0.7	13.6 $\pm$ 0.0	1.2 $\pm$ 0.2	2.7 $\pm$ 0.1	8.9 $\pm$ 1.3	6.3 $\pm$ 0.1	13.9 $\pm$ 1.1	12.1 $\pm$ 0.5
DiffusionDB-10k	SimCLR	67.3 $\pm$ 0.1	36.2 $\pm$ 0.4	4.3 $\pm$ 0.2	8.8 $\pm$ 0.1	26.8 $\pm$ 0.4	17.3 $\pm$ 0.1	36.7 $\pm$ 0.8	28.2 $\pm$ 0.3
	TS	64.7 $\pm$ 0.4	33.6 $\pm$ 0.3	3.1 $\pm$ 0.5	7.3 $\pm$ 0.3	23.2 $\pm$ 0.4	17.0 $\pm$ 0.0	37.8 $\pm$ 0.6	26.7 $\pm$ 0.4
	SDCLR	32.6 $\pm$ 1.2	10.0 $\pm$ 0.3	1.3 $\pm$ 0.1	2.2 $\pm$ 0.2	6.1 $\pm$ 0.7	4.8 $\pm$ 0.4	10.6 $\pm$ 0.5	9.7 $\pm$ 0.5
	BRIDGE (ours)	68.1 $\pm$ 0.3	37.0 $\pm$ 0.2	5.4 $\pm$ 0.5	9.5 $\pm$ 0.1	30.4 $\pm$ 0.4	18.5 $\pm$ 0.1	39.9 $\pm$ 0.6	29.8 $\pm$ 0.3
	BRIDGE+TS (ours)	57.2 $\pm$ 0.7	25.6 $\pm$ 1.0	2.8 $\pm$ 0.3	6.8 $\pm$ 0.1	22.3 $\pm$ 0.5	15.4 $\pm$ 0.6	37.3 $\pm$ 0.6	23.9 $\pm$ 0.6
	BRIDGE+SDCLR (ours)	37.1 $\pm$ 1.3	11.8 $\pm$ 0.9	1.3 $\pm$ 0.1	2.2 $\pm$ 0.2	6.8 $\pm$ 0.5	5.9 $\pm$ 0.7	12.5 $\pm$ 0.7	11.1 $\pm$ 0.6

NeurIPS Paper Checklist

1. Claims

Question: Do the main claims made in the abstract and introduction accurately reflect the paper’s contributions and scope?

Answer: [\[Yes\]](#)

Table 8: Pretraining objective ablation with full linear-probe results.

Setting	C10	C100	Cars	Aircraft	Flowers	Pets	IN100-LT	Avg.
SimCLR	71.8 ± 1.2	43.5 ± 0.5	9.0 ± 0.5	16.9 ± 0.3	27.2 ± 1.5	33.2 ± 3.3	41.7 ± 1.3	34.7 ± 1.2
MoCo	46.6 ± 3.1	18.4 ± 2.0	3.1 ± 0.5	4.3 ± 0.8	10.4 ± 3.2	15.0 ± 1.8	26.6 ± 1.9	17.8 ± 1.9
DINO	43.6 ± 0.7	17.8 ± 0.6	1.3 ± 0.5	1.6 ± 0.2	12.6 ± 4.4	8.7 ± 1.6	20.6 ± 1.1	15.2 ± 1.3

Table 9: Pretraining objective ablation with full kNN results.

Setting	C10	C100	Cars	Aircraft	Flowers	Pets	IN100-LT	Avg.
SimCLR	66.3 ± 0.8	35.3 ± 0.4	5.1 ± 0.7	9.5 ± 0.1	24.8 ± 0.6	18.9 ± 1.0	36.7 ± 0.7	28.1 ± 0.6
MoCo	56.4 ± 1.6	25.9 ± 0.8	3.2 ± 0.4	5.2 ± 0.4	16.3 ± 1.1	12.2 ± 0.7	24.3 ± 0.7	20.5 ± 0.8
DINO	34.4 ± 0.2	12.4 ± 0.1	1.6 ± 0.1	2.4 ± 0.1	6.2 ± 0.8	5.4 ± 0.4	10.7 ± 0.8	10.4 ± 0.4

Justification: The abstract and introduction restrict the claims to the completed five source regimes, the evaluated baselines and ablations, and the observed average transfer gains. Limitations are stated explicitly in Section 6.

Guidelines:

- The answer NA means that the abstract and introduction do not include the claims made in the paper.
- The abstract and/or introduction should clearly state the claims made, including the contributions made in the paper and important assumptions and limitations. A No or NA answer to this question will not be perceived well by the reviewers.
- The claims made should match theoretical and experimental results, and reflect how much the results can be expected to generalize to other settings.
- It is fine to include aspirational goals as motivation as long as it is clear that these goals are not attained by the paper.

2. Limitations

Question: Does the paper discuss the limitations of the work performed by the authors?

Answer: [\[Yes\]](#)

Justification: Section 6 discusses compute cost, subset size constraints for PASS and DiffusionDB, the focus on ResNet-50 in the main text, and the absence of post project baselines. Appendix C expands on the compute budget.

Guidelines:

- The answer NA means that the paper has no limitation while the answer No means that the paper has limitations, but those are not discussed in the paper.
- The authors are encouraged to create a separate "Limitations" section in their paper.
- The paper should point out any strong assumptions and how robust the results are to violations of these assumptions (e.g., independence assumptions, noiseless settings, model well-specification, asymptotic approximations only holding locally). The authors should reflect on how these assumptions might be violated in practice and what the implications would be.
- The authors should reflect on the scope of the claims made, e.g., if the approach was only tested on a few datasets or with a few runs. In general, empirical results often depend on implicit assumptions, which should be articulated.
- The authors should reflect on the factors that influence the performance of the approach. For example, a facial recognition algorithm may perform poorly when image resolution is low or images are taken in low lighting. Or a speech-to-text system might not be used reliably to provide closed captions for online lectures because it fails to handle technical jargon.
- The authors should discuss the computational efficiency of the proposed algorithms and how they scale with dataset size.
- If applicable, the authors should discuss possible limitations of their approach to address problems of privacy and fairness.

Table 10: Augmentation mechanism ablation with full linear-probe results.

Setting	C10	C100	Cars	Aircraft	Flowers	Pets	IN100-LT	Avg.
Stable Diffusion 3	75.0 $\pm$ 0.2	48.4 $\pm$ 0.2	15.1 $\pm$ 1.2	20.6 $\pm$ 0.7	37.4 $\pm$ 2.0	41.2 $\pm$ 0.7	51.8 $\pm$ 1.1	41.4 $\pm$ 0.8
FLUX	70.7 $\pm$ 0.4	42.1 $\pm$ 1.4	10.3 $\pm$ 1.3	17.5 $\pm$ 0.9	29.4 $\pm$ 4.6	31.5 $\pm$ 2.9	43.7 $\pm$ 1.4	35.0 $\pm$ 1.9
Re-population	67.0 $\pm$ 2.6	39.4 $\pm$ 2.2	8.0 $\pm$ 0.6	15.4 $\pm$ 0.5	25.7 $\pm$ 1.4	31.7 $\pm$ 3.8	40.6 $\pm$ 0.5	32.6 $\pm$ 1.7

Table 11: Augmentation mechanism ablation with full kNN results.

Setting	C10	C100	Cars	Aircraft	Flowers	Pets	IN100-LT	Avg.
Stable Diffusion 3	68.3 $\pm$ 0.4	36.8 $\pm$ 0.2	6.5 $\pm$ 0.4	11.7 $\pm$ 0.6	35.1 $\pm$ 0.4	24.2 $\pm$ 0.3	45.9 $\pm$ 0.5	32.7 $\pm$ 0.4
FLUX	65.8 $\pm$ 1.0	35.4 $\pm$ 0.8	5.7 $\pm$ 0.7	9.4 $\pm$ 0.9	27.7 $\pm$ 1.0	18.8 $\pm$ 1.3	38.7 $\pm$ 1.2	28.8 $\pm$ 1.0
Re-population	64.5 $\pm$ 0.1	33.4 $\pm$ 0.6	4.2 $\pm$ 0.6	9.0 $\pm$ 0.4	23.0 $\pm$ 0.5	17.0 $\pm$ 0.4	34.2 $\pm$ 1.2	26.5 $\pm$ 0.5

- While the authors might fear that complete honesty about limitations might be used by reviewers as grounds for rejection, a worse outcome might be that reviewers discover limitations that aren't acknowledged in the paper. The authors should use their best judgment and recognize that individual actions in favor of transparency play an important role in developing norms that preserve the integrity of the community. Reviewers will be specifically instructed to not penalize honesty concerning limitations.

3. Theory assumptions and proofs

Question: For each theoretical result, does the paper provide the full set of assumptions and a complete (and correct) proof?

Answer: [NA]

Justification: The paper is empirical. It does not claim a formal theorem or proof.

Guidelines:

- The answer NA means that the paper does not include theoretical results.
- All the theorems, formulas, and proofs in the paper should be numbered and cross-referenced.
- All assumptions should be clearly stated or referenced in the statement of any theorems.
- The proofs can either appear in the main paper or the supplemental material, but if they appear in the supplemental material, the authors are encouraged to provide a short proof sketch to provide intuition.
- Inversely, any informal proof provided in the core of the paper should be complemented by formal proofs provided in appendix or supplemental material.
- Theorems and Lemmas that the proof relies upon should be properly referenced.

4. Experimental result reproducibility

Question: Does the paper fully disclose all the information needed to reproduce the main experimental results of the paper to the extent that it affects the main claims and/or conclusions of the paper (regardless of whether the code and data are provided or not)?

Answer: [Yes]

Justification: Sections 3 to 5 specify the source regimes, targets, training schedule, selection rule, generator choices, and evaluation protocol. Appendix B adds the exact budgets, splits, and reporting procedure.

Guidelines:

- The answer NA means that the paper does not include experiments.
- If the paper includes experiments, a No answer to this question will not be perceived well by the reviewers: Making the paper reproducible is important, regardless of whether the code and data are provided or not.
- If the contribution is a dataset and/or model, the authors should describe the steps taken to make their results reproducible or verifiable.

Table 12: Sample-selection strategy ablation with full linear-probe results.

Setting	C10	C100	Cars	Aircraft	Flowers	Pets	IN100-LT	Avg.
Mode window	71.9 ± 0.3	43.4 ± 0.7	9.0 ± 0.5	16.9 ± 0.2	27.9 ± 3.1	31.6 ± 3.3	41.7 ± 1.3	34.6 ± 1.3
Top tail	70.8 ± 0.5	43.1 ± 1.0	10.0 ± 1.7	15.9 ± 1.3	27.7 ± 1.0	30.5 ± 1.2	42.2 ± 1.4	34.3 ± 1.2
Uniform	71.5 ± 0.2	43.8 ± 0.7	9.3 ± 0.9	17.5 ± 1.2	32.9 ± 0.4	31.7 ± 3.9	42.0 ± 0.9	35.5 ± 1.2

Table 13: Sample-selection strategy ablation with full kNN results.

Setting	C10	C100	Cars	Aircraft	Flowers	Pets	IN100-LT	Avg.
Mode window	66.3 ± 0.8	35.3 ± 0.4	5.1 ± 0.7	9.5 ± 0.1	24.8 ± 0.6	18.9 ± 1.0	36.7 ± 0.7	28.1 ± 0.6
Top tail	65.7 ± 0.8	34.4 ± 0.2	4.1 ± 0.4	9.6 ± 0.2	23.9 ± 0.9	18.1 ± 0.8	35.4 ± 1.2	27.3 ± 0.6
Uniform	66.1 ± 1.0	35.7 ± 0.3	4.9 ± 0.1	10.2 ± 0.7	25.3 ± 0.4	19.0 ± 0.8	37.4 ± 0.6	28.4 ± 0.6

- Depending on the contribution, reproducibility can be accomplished in various ways. For example, if the contribution is a novel architecture, describing the architecture fully might suffice, or if the contribution is a specific model and empirical evaluation, it may be necessary to either make it possible for others to replicate the model with the same dataset, or provide access to the model. In general, releasing code and data is often one good way to accomplish this, but reproducibility can also be provided via detailed instructions for how to replicate the results, access to a hosted model (e.g., in the case of a large language model), releasing of a model checkpoint, or other means that are appropriate to the research performed.
- While NeurIPS does not require releasing code, the conference does require all submissions to provide some reasonable avenue for reproducibility, which may depend on the nature of the contribution. For example
 - (a) If the contribution is primarily a new algorithm, the paper should make it clear how to reproduce that algorithm.
 - (b) If the contribution is primarily a new model architecture, the paper should describe the architecture clearly and fully.
 - (c) If the contribution is a new model (e.g., a large language model), then there should either be a way to access this model for reproducing the results or a way to reproduce the model (e.g., with an open-source dataset or instructions for how to construct the dataset).
 - (d) We recognize that reproducibility may be tricky in some cases, in which case authors are welcome to describe the particular way they provide for reproducibility. In the case of closed-source models, it may be that access to the model is limited in some way (e.g., to registered users), but it should be possible for other researchers to have some path to reproducing or verifying the results.

5. Open access to data and code

Question: Does the paper provide open access to the data and code, with sufficient instructions to faithfully reproduce the main experimental results, as described in supplemental material?

Answer: [No]

Justification: The submission includes detailed experimental instructions in the appendix, but it does not attach an anonymized public code or data release. The paper only relies on existing public datasets and model releases under their original terms.

Guidelines:

- The answer NA means that paper does not include experiments requiring code.
- Please see the NeurIPS code and data submission guidelines (<https://nips.cc/public/guides/CodeSubmissionPolicy>) for more details.
- While we encourage the release of code and data, we understand that this might not be possible, so "No" is an acceptable answer. Papers cannot be rejected simply for not including code, unless this is central to the contribution (e.g., for a new open-source benchmark).

Table 14: Cycle count ablation with full linear-probe results.

Setting	C10	C100	Cars	Aircraft	Flowers	Pets	IN100-LT	Avg.
2 cycles	67.9 $\pm$ 0.6	40.7 $\pm$ 0.6	9.4 $\pm$ 1.8	16.0 $\pm$ 1.5	30.5 $\pm$ 3.2	27.4 $\pm$ 1.7	40.1 $\pm$ 0.4	33.1 $\pm$ 1.4
10 cycles	70.5 $\pm$ 1.2	43.8 $\pm$ 0.6	9.2 $\pm$ 0.9	17.2 $\pm$ 1.6	24.8 $\pm$ 5.2	31.3 $\pm$ 1.7	41.9 $\pm$ 0.6	34.1 $\pm$ 1.7
20 cycles	71.6 $\pm$ 1.1	44.6 $\pm$ 0.9	9.8 $\pm$ 0.3	17.3 $\pm$ 1.2	27.0 $\pm$ 2.1	33.3 $\pm$ 4.4	42.1 $\pm$ 1.5	35.1 $\pm$ 1.6
5 cycles	70.7 $\pm$ 1.7	43.3 $\pm$ 0.6	9.9 $\pm$ 1.5	16.4 $\pm$ 0.9	26.6 $\pm$ 2.7	31.2 $\pm$ 3.7	42.0 $\pm$ 1.2	34.3 $\pm$ 1.8

Table 15: Cycle count ablation with full kNN results.

Setting	C10	C100	Cars	Aircraft	Flowers	Pets	IN100-LT	Avg.
2 cycles	65.1 $\pm$ 0.1	34.1 $\pm$ 0.5	4.6 $\pm$ 0.3	9.3 $\pm$ 0.3	23.8 $\pm$ 0.3	17.3 $\pm$ 0.7	34.5 $\pm$ 0.6	26.9 $\pm$ 0.4
10 cycles	66.4 $\pm$ 0.5	35.4 $\pm$ 0.3	4.8 $\pm$ 0.3	10.4 $\pm$ 0.6	25.2 $\pm$ 0.8	18.6 $\pm$ 0.9	36.0 $\pm$ 0.7	28.1 $\pm$ 0.6
20 cycles	66.5 $\pm$ 0.7	35.6 $\pm$ 0.8	4.8 $\pm$ 0.3	9.5 $\pm$ 0.4	24.9 $\pm$ 0.5	18.6 $\pm$ 1.2	36.3 $\pm$ 1.2	28.0 $\pm$ 0.7
5 cycles	66.0 $\pm$ 0.9	35.0 $\pm$ 0.9	5.0 $\pm$ 0.4	9.8 $\pm$ 0.2	24.8 $\pm$ 0.4	18.0 $\pm$ 0.5	35.6 $\pm$ 1.2	27.7 $\pm$ 0.6

- The instructions should contain the exact command and environment needed to run to reproduce the results. See the NeurIPS code and data submission guidelines (<https://nips.cc/public/guides/CodeSubmissionPolicy>) for more details.
- The authors should provide instructions on data access and preparation, including how to access the raw data, preprocessed data, intermediate data, and generated data, etc.
- The authors should provide scripts to reproduce all experimental results for the new proposed method and baselines. If only a subset of experiments are reproducible, they should state which ones are omitted from the script and why.
- At submission time, to preserve anonymity, the authors should release anonymized versions (if applicable).
- Providing as much information as possible in supplemental material (appended to the paper) is recommended, but including URLs to data and code is permitted.

6. Experimental setting/details

Question: Does the paper specify all the training and test details (e.g., data splits, hyper-parameters, how they were chosen, type of optimizer, etc.) necessary to understand the results?

Answer: [Yes]

Justification: The main text states the source datasets, targets, cycles, budgets, and evaluation metrics. Appendix B adds the exact OOD scoring, selection, generation, and split details.

Guidelines:

- The answer NA means that the paper does not include experiments.
- The experimental setting should be presented in the core of the paper to a level of detail that is necessary to appreciate the results and make sense of them.
- The full details can be provided either with the code, in appendix, or as supplemental material.

7. Experiment statistical significance

Question: Does the paper report error bars suitably and correctly defined or other appropriate information about the statistical significance of the experiments?

Answer: [Yes]

Justification: All main and appendix tables report mean $\pm$ standard deviation over three independent seeds, and Section 4 states this explicitly. The figures in Appendix A visualize the same aggregate trends.

Guidelines:

- The answer NA means that the paper does not include experiments.
- The authors should answer "Yes" if the results are accompanied by error bars, confidence intervals, or statistical significance tests, at least for the experiments that support the main claims of the paper.

Table 16: Backbone architecture ablation with full linear-probe results.

Setting	C10	C100	Cars	Aircraft	Flowers	Pets	IN100-LT	Avg.
ResNet-18	67.7 $\pm$ 0.8	40.4 $\pm$ 0.5	10.6 $\pm$ 0.7	15.4 $\pm$ 0.3	26.1 $\pm$ 2.4	29.5 $\pm$ 2.7	41.0 $\pm$ 1.2	32.9 $\pm$ 1.2
ResNet-50	71.7 $\pm$ 1.0	44.0 $\pm$ 1.1	9.0 $\pm$ 0.5	17.4 $\pm$ 0.7	28.8 $\pm$ 1.7	32.0 $\pm$ 1.6	41.7 $\pm$ 1.3	34.9 $\pm$ 1.1
ViT-S	62.7 $\pm$ 0.4	37.6 $\pm$ 0.6	8.8 $\pm$ 0.5	12.2 $\pm$ 0.2	35.1 $\pm$ 4.2	30.2 $\pm$ 1.6	42.5 $\pm$ 1.2	32.7 $\pm$ 1.3
ViT-B	66.0 $\pm$ 2.3	40.6 $\pm$ 2.3	8.3 $\pm$ 0.5	14.3 $\pm$ 0.8	38.8 $\pm$ 2.6	31.3 $\pm$ 2.1	44.5 $\pm$ 1.7	34.8 $\pm$ 1.8

Table 17: Backbone architecture ablation with full kNN results.

Setting	C10	C100	Cars	Aircraft	Flowers	Pets	IN100-LT	Avg.
ResNet-18	65.0 $\pm$ 0.3	34.4 $\pm$ 0.3	4.7 $\pm$ 0.3	9.6 $\pm$ 0.4	23.5 $\pm$ 1.4	16.6 $\pm$ 0.3	36.3 $\pm$ 1.1	27.2 $\pm$ 0.6
ResNet-50	66.3 $\pm$ 0.8	35.3 $\pm$ 0.4	5.1 $\pm$ 0.7	9.5 $\pm$ 0.1	24.8 $\pm$ 0.6	18.9 $\pm$ 1.0	36.7 $\pm$ 0.7	28.1 $\pm$ 0.6
ViT-S	67.3 $\pm$ 0.4	37.5 $\pm$ 0.3	5.3 $\pm$ 0.2	7.6 $\pm$ 0.1	36.2 $\pm$ 0.7	20.1 $\pm$ 1.0	42.1 $\pm$ 1.0	30.9 $\pm$ 0.5
ViT-B	69.3 $\pm$ 0.8	40.1 $\pm$ 0.8	6.0 $\pm$ 0.2	8.3 $\pm$ 0.2	39.8 $\pm$ 0.8	21.9 $\pm$ 1.4	45.1 $\pm$ 0.7	32.9 $\pm$ 0.7

- The factors of variability that the error bars are capturing should be clearly stated (for example, train/test split, initialization, random drawing of some parameter, or overall run with given experimental conditions).
- The method for calculating the error bars should be explained (closed form formula, call to a library function, bootstrap, etc.)
- The assumptions made should be given (e.g., Normally distributed errors).
- It should be clear whether the error bar is the standard deviation or the standard error of the mean.
- It is OK to report 1-sigma error bars, but one should state it. The authors should preferably report a 2-sigma error bar than state that they have a 96% CI, if the hypothesis of Normality of errors is not verified.
- For asymmetric distributions, the authors should be careful not to show in tables or plots symmetric error bars that would yield results that are out of range (e.g. negative error rates).
- If error bars are reported in tables or plots, The authors should explain in the text how they were calculated and reference the corresponding figures or tables in the text.

8. Experiments compute resources

Question: For each experiment, does the paper provide sufficient information on the computer resources (type of compute workers, memory, time of execution) needed to reproduce the experiments?

Answer: [Yes]

Justification: Appendix C specifies the GPU type, node configuration, wall time regime, representative runtimes, and aggregate successful compute. It also states that the full project compute was higher due to failed and pilot jobs.

Guidelines:

- The answer NA means that the paper does not include experiments.
- The paper should indicate the type of compute workers CPU or GPU, internal cluster, or cloud provider, including relevant memory and storage.
- The paper should provide the amount of compute required for each of the individual experimental runs as well as estimate the total compute.
- The paper should disclose whether the full research project required more compute than the experiments reported in the paper (e.g., preliminary or failed experiments that didn't make it into the paper).

9. Code of ethics

Question: Does the research conducted in the paper conform, in every respect, with the NeurIPS Code of Ethics <https://neurips.cc/public/EthicsGuidelines?>

Answer: [Yes]

Justification: The work uses existing public datasets and model releases under their published terms, stays within academic research usage, and does not involve human subjects or undisclosed conflicts.

Guidelines:

- The answer NA means that the authors have not reviewed the NeurIPS Code of Ethics.
- If the authors answer No, they should explain the special circumstances that require a deviation from the Code of Ethics.
- The authors should make sure to preserve anonymity (e.g., if there is a special consideration due to laws or regulations in their jurisdiction).

10. Broader impacts

Question: Does the paper discuss both potential positive societal impacts and negative societal impacts of the work performed?

Answer: [Yes]

Justification: Appendix E discusses potential benefits for biased data regimes as well as risks tied to web sourced datasets and image generators, including privacy, licensing, and harmful content concerns.

Guidelines:

- The answer NA means that there is no societal impact of the work performed.
- If the authors answer NA or No, they should explain why their work has no societal impact or why the paper does not address societal impact.
- Examples of negative societal impacts include potential malicious or unintended uses (e.g., disinformation, generating fake profiles, surveillance), fairness considerations (e.g., deployment of technologies that could make decisions that unfairly impact specific groups), privacy considerations, and security considerations.
- The conference expects that many papers will be foundational research and not tied to particular applications, let alone deployments. However, if there is a direct path to any negative applications, the authors should point it out. For example, it is legitimate to point out that an improvement in the quality of generative models could be used to generate deepfakes for disinformation. On the other hand, it is not needed to point out that a generic algorithm for optimizing neural networks could enable people to train models that generate Deepfakes faster.
- The authors should consider possible harms that could arise when the technology is being used as intended and functioning correctly, harms that could arise when the technology is being used as intended but gives incorrect results, and harms following from (intentional or unintentional) misuse of the technology.
- If there are negative societal impacts, the authors could also discuss possible mitigation strategies (e.g., gated release of models, providing defenses in addition to attacks, mechanisms for monitoring misuse, mechanisms to monitor how a system learns from feedback over time, improving the efficiency and accessibility of ML).

11. Safeguards

Question: Does the paper describe safeguards that have been put in place for responsible release of data or models that have a high risk for misuse (e.g., pretrained language models, image generators, or scraped datasets)?

Answer: [NA]

Justification: The submission does not release a new generator, a new scraped dataset, or a new model checkpoint. It uses existing assets under their published access controls and terms.

Guidelines:

- The answer NA means that the paper poses no such risks.
- Released models that have a high risk for misuse or dual-use should be released with necessary safeguards to allow for controlled use of the model, for example by requiring that users adhere to usage guidelines or restrictions to access the model or implementing safety filters.

- Datasets that have been scraped from the Internet could pose safety risks. The authors should describe how they avoided releasing unsafe images.
- We recognize that providing effective safeguards is challenging, and many papers do not require this, but we encourage authors to take this into account and make a best faith effort.

12. Licenses for existing assets

Question: Are the creators or original owners of assets (e.g., code, data, models), used in the paper, properly credited and are the license and terms of use explicitly mentioned and properly respected?

Answer: [Yes]

Justification: Appendix D names the primary datasets and generators and states the official license or access terms that apply to them. The paper cites the original dataset and model papers throughout.

Guidelines:

- The answer NA means that the paper does not use existing assets.
- The authors should cite the original paper that produced the code package or dataset.
- The authors should state which version of the asset is used and, if possible, include a URL.
- The name of the license (e.g., CC-BY 4.0) should be included for each asset.
- For scraped data from a particular source (e.g., website), the copyright and terms of service of that source should be provided.
- If assets are released, the license, copyright information, and terms of use in the package should be provided. For popular datasets, paperswithcode.com/datasets has curated licenses for some datasets. Their licensing guide can help determine the license of a dataset.
- For existing datasets that are re-packaged, both the original license and the license of the derived asset (if it has changed) should be provided.
- If this information is not available online, the authors are encouraged to reach out to the asset's creators.

13. New assets

Question: Are new assets introduced in the paper well documented and is the documentation provided alongside the assets?

Answer: [NA]

Justification: The paper does not release a new dataset, model, or code package.

Guidelines:

- The answer NA means that the paper does not release new assets.
- Researchers should communicate the details of the dataset/code/model as part of their submissions via structured templates. This includes details about training, license, limitations, etc.
- The paper should discuss whether and how consent was obtained from people whose asset is used.
- At submission time, remember to anonymize your assets (if applicable). You can either create an anonymized URL or include an anonymized zip file.

14. Crowdsourcing and research with human subjects

Question: For crowdsourcing experiments and research with human subjects, does the paper include the full text of instructions given to participants and screenshots, if applicable, as well as details about compensation (if any)?

Answer: [NA]

Justification: The paper does not involve crowdsourcing or research with human subjects.

Guidelines:

- The answer NA means that the paper does not involve crowdsourcing nor research with human subjects.
- Including this information in the supplemental material is fine, but if the main contribution of the paper involves human subjects, then as much detail as possible should be included in the main paper.
- According to the NeurIPS Code of Ethics, workers involved in data collection, curation, or other labor should be paid at least the minimum wage in the country of the data collector.

15. Institutional review board (IRB) approvals or equivalent for research with human subjects

Question: Does the paper describe potential risks incurred by study participants, whether such risks were disclosed to the subjects, and whether Institutional Review Board (IRB) approvals (or an equivalent approval/review based on the requirements of your country or institution) were obtained?

Answer: [NA]

Justification: The paper does not involve crowdsourcing or research with human subjects.

Guidelines:

- The answer NA means that the paper does not involve crowdsourcing nor research with human subjects.
- Depending on the country in which research is conducted, IRB approval (or equivalent) may be required for any human subjects research. If you obtained IRB approval, you should clearly state this in the paper.
- We recognize that the procedures for this may vary significantly between institutions and locations, and we expect authors to adhere to the NeurIPS Code of Ethics and the guidelines for their institution.
- For initial submissions, do not include any information that would break anonymity (if applicable), such as the institution conducting the review.

16. Declaration of LLM usage

Question: Does the paper describe the usage of LLMs if it is an important, original, or non-standard component of the core methods in this research? Note that if the LLM is used only for writing, editing, or formatting purposes and does not impact the core methodology, scientific rigor, or originality of the research, declaration is not required.

Answer: [NA]

Justification: LLMs are not part of the proposed method, the experiments, or the scientific claims.

Guidelines:

- The answer NA means that the core method development in this research does not involve LLMs as any important, original, or non-standard components.
- Please refer to our LLM policy (<https://neurips.cc/Conferences/2025/LLM>) for what should or should not be described.